

# C3.ai

Enterprise AI applications for manufacturing, energy, defense and financial services · [c3.ai](#)

2009

Founded

~1,000–1,180

Employees

\$389M (FY2025)

Revenue (latest/est.)

Public

Ownership

2.9/5

Glassdoor (825)

No

Digital twin

## 01 Overview

Public but smaller and less differentiated than Palantir, with real recent strain: revenue growth has decelerated sharply, founder Tom Siebel resumed the CEO role in May 2026 after a health-related leadership change, and Glassdoor sentiment has fallen from 3.1 to 2.9 over the past year.

**Offering:** C3 Agentic AI Platform (end-to-end build/deploy/operate environment) plus 40+ prebuilt, industry-specific Enterprise AI applications and C3 Generative AI tools.

### Key facts

**HQ:** Redwood City, CA

**Ownership:** Public (NYSE: AI)

**Revenue:** \$389.1M (FY2025), up 25% YoY; quarterly revenue has since decelerated (Q4 FY2026: \$51.6M)

**Web:** [c3.ai](#) · [LinkedIn](#)

**Key people:** Thomas M. Siebel (Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer) · Stephen Ehikian (President) · Edward Abbo (Chief Technology Officer)

**Digital twin:** No · **GenAI:** Yes

## 02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

| Sector             | Deployment                                                 | Reported impact                                                                                            | Source               |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Energy (oil & gas) | Shell — predictive maintenance at scale                    | Scaled AI predictive maintenance to 10,000 pieces of equipment                                             | <a href="#">Link</a> |
| Energy (JV)        | Baker Hughes — industrial asset management JV              | 6-year, \$495M minimum commitment (through June 2025); Baker Hughes holds an equity stake and a board seat | <a href="#">Link</a> |
| Chemicals          | LyondellBasell — five-year expanded enterprise AI contract | Contract expansion signed to accelerate enterprise AI deployment across operations                         | <a href="#">Link</a> |

## 03 Competitive Landscape

**Other vendors in this market:** Sand Technologies · Palantir Technologies · Cognite · Bentley Systems · AVEVA · IBM watsonx · Honeywell Forge · Siemens Xcelerator

**Where it sits:** Closest comparable to Sand on “vertical AI applications” positioning, but sells software licenses/subscriptions rather than the services-heavy delivery model Sand uses — and is currently the most stressed name on this list financially and organizationally.

## 04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock’s dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.

| Entity                         | Possible connection                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Global Infrastructure Partners | No connection found. None of C3.ai’s named customers (Shell, Baker Hughes, Bank of America, U.S. Air Force/Army, Cargill, Koch) are GIP portfolio companies.                                                        |
| BlackRock                      | Confirmed passive ownership — 6.8% of shares outstanding per BlackRock’s April 2026 Schedule 13G/A filing, its largest disclosed institutional holder after Vanguard (6.1%) and founder Thomas Siebel’s combined... |

## 05 Sentiment

**Customer:** Public case studies (Shell, Baker Hughes, LyondellBasell) show real deployed scale, but G2/Gartner Peer Insights review volume is modest for a public company of this size, and the JV-heavy customer base makes independent reference-checking harder than for a typical SaaS vendor.

### What supports the story

- Broad partner ecosystem — six-year Microsoft Azure partnership, plus AWS and Google Cloud alliances
- Federal/defense bookings grew 134% YoY in a recent quarter as government AI demand accelerates
- 40+ prebuilt industry applications shorten deployment time versus building from scratch

### What to pressure-test

- Customer concentration risk: Baker Hughes has historically been ~20–30% of revenue via a JV with renegotiated minimums
- Quarterly revenue has decelerated markedly (Q3 FY2025 from \$98.8M in Q3 FY2025 to \$51.6M in Q4 FY2026, per filings)
- Founder Tom Siebel stepped back for health reasons in Sept 2025, then resumed the CEO role in May 2026 — real leadership turbulence

**Employee:** Recent reviews cite a sharp deterioration — “sinking ship” language and reports of aggressive attrition — a marked reversal from C3.ai’s earlier “highest-rated cloud company to work for” recognition (Battery Ventures/Glassdoor, ~2021).

Sources: C3.ai public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked “est.” or “not disclosed” are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.